



Piki Mabel Nokhuthula, From Zimbabwe

“A call to action!”

Piki Mabel

In the whispers of the wind, the warning cries, Yet skeptics linger, turning a blind eye. Evidence clear, like the storm's fierce roar, Yet propaganda shields us, closing every door. “Climate change”, they scoff, a name they disdain, But nature's fury echoes, a relentless refrain. Floods and fires rage, lives lost in the fray, Will a new name awaken, bring light to the day? What if we call it ‘Earth's urgent plea’?

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“Valleys and Sessions”

Fehmeeda

The summer of 2025 was a journey of connection, growth, and exploration across both Upper and Lower Chitral.

Laspur Valley: Education Expo, visits to Baba-e-Laspur Library, Laspur Museum, handicraft centers, and camping station.

Islamabad: First in-person team meetup.

Gobor Valley: Team-led visit for a documentary.

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Zeeshan Wali, Vice President Gilgit Wing

“Between the Breaths”

By Shan

I want to sleep, but sleep won't stay,
It slips like time, just fades away.
I want to read, to build, to try—
But pages blur beneath my eye.

I want to live, but life feels still,
A mountain moved by no strong will.
I want to die, but breath won't cease,
A war inside, no chance for peace.

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Anika Sher, President Gilgit Wing

“A Journey of Hearts: Yaran e Khair Flood Relief Mission”

Anika Sher

The story began quietly with a single notification on my phone. Scrolling through I saw heartbreaking images of Ghizer homes washed away, families standing in knee-deep water, farmlands drowned, shops destroyed, animals lost, lives changed forever. For a moment, I froze. I am just a student. What could I possibly do for them? A wild thought flashed through my mind: If I were a billionaire, I'd rebuild everything. But then reality whispered, Even small hands

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“DEMISE OF HOPES”

Muhammad Numan

A scorching day was about to conclude. The sun was hardly visible behind the tall Mountains of Tirah valley. It was all orange and red in the sky. A cold breeze was sweeping the barren and dusty grounds of the valley. In between the mountains, on the dusty terrain, a military vehicle was rushing towards the camp after accomplishing a lengthy mission against a group that had been carrying out attacks on the soldiers and civilians for two months now. It was all smiles and chuckles inside the vehicle, but Major Azan was more excited to return to his daughter back home after four long months. But some times, our written fates are like a thriller movie: unexpected twists and unanticipated consequences. It took only 30 minutes for the laughs to turn into wails. Soaked in blood

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It is a pet of Fizza Khan.

“From Stray to Stay”

Fizza Khan

This is the story of how on a random Sunday I did something so fulfilling it inspired me to continue doing it for the rest of my life. Back in December of 2019 I was on my way back home from school and saw this tiny black kitten limping near our gate, before I could even call for help he ran to me and hid behind my leg and would not leave. I knew right then I couldn't just leave him there so I brought him inside. My sister and I gave him warm milk, cleaned his dusty fur and let him get used to our terrace. He slept peacefully for hours with a full belly,

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Picture taken in Yakaki, Indonesia. Nasywa is enjoying the conversations with the kids.

“Smiles that Teach”

Nasywa Sukindra

The days are warm, the sun gleams over Jakarta. In the summer of 2025, I met the children of YKAKI, the Indonesia Care for Cancer Kids Foundation in Jakarta. Curious eyes greeted me as I stepped in, along with laughter and playful shouts. It was my first time volunteering to teach, yet I froze in place, astonished. How could I possibly teach children who were bravely fighting cancer? What knowledge did I truly have to offer them?

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“Rang e Yaran: Apna Camp Apni Story”

Naila Sarwar

Rang e Yaran Camp was one of the most enriching memorable experiences.



I have been part of under Yaran e Khair. It was designed to bring young minds together in a space filled with learning, creativity, and reflection. Through this camp, we aimed to help participants explore themselves, connect with others, and develop a deeper understanding of teamwork and leadership.

Throughout the day, we conducted a series of interactive and thought-provoking activities. Each session carried a unique purpose; some encouraged personal reflection, while others focused on communication, expression, and emotional growth. I really enjoyed seeing how actively everyone participated and how comfortable they felt sharing their thoughts and experiences.

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“Dream Gurl”

Aziz Karim

Nearly four years had drifted by since our graduation, and in that time, our paths had never crossed.



One day, a mysterious call broke the silence, and its number was unknown to me. She was a girl with a voice that was familiar to me. Without wasting a moment, she said, “Hello, Akbar, you didn't change your phone number yet. Thank God.” I cleared my throat and asked, “Do I know you?”. Her laughter intensified while she said, “I don't know if you still remember me, but I still commemorate you. Leave all this aside, , I am getting married next week.” She took a pause, saying this, and I didn't say anything either. Her voice lowered when she came up with the invitation of her wedding.

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Opinion Page

A farce called 'peace plan'

Zahid Hussain

PRESIDENT Donald Trump has finally unveiled his much-touted 20-point plan for a ceasefire in Gaza, which he describes as a landmark deal to end two years of a devastating war.

But in reality, it's a document of surrender for the Palestinian resistance against a brutal occupation. It has sanctified the genocide, carried out by the Zionist forces, which has killed tens of thousands of people, mostly women and children, and has uprooted the entire population of the occupied land.

In fact, it's a declaration of victory for a state accused of war crimes. Former British prime minister Tony Blair and Trump's son-in-law Jared Kushner have played a key role in preparing the so-called peace plan. Kushner was also the driving force behind the Abraham Accords during Trump's first term as president.

To read the whole article visit:

<https://www.dawn.com/news/1903912/another-layer-of-control>

Empowered ageing

Laila Akbar Cassum

THIS year's theme for International Day of Older Persons, observed on Oct 1 each year, is 'Older Persons Driving Local and Global Action: Our Aspirations, Our Well-Being, Our Rights'. This theme resonates with Pakistan's changing demographic landscape, urging us to see our elderly population not simply as recipients of care, but as vibrant contributors who shape our communities, society and nation.

The WHO predicts that by 2050, the number of individuals aged 60 and above will double, reaching 2.1 billion. In Pakistan, the population of older adults is expected to surge from 11.3 million in 2017 to over 43.3m by 2050. The focus on the elderly in Pakistan has tended to be on the burden and dependency associated with old age, overlooking the aspirations of older adults and the invaluable role they play in eastern societies.

To read the whole article visit:

<https://www.dawn.com/news/1903912/another-layer-of-control>

The philanthropy gap

Aisha Irshad Mian

WITH one in four Pakistanis suffering and over Rs250 billion lost annually, the refusal to fund mental health is philanthropy's costliest neglect.

Despite mental health disorders being among the leading causes of disability worldwide, philanthropy continues to look the other way. While billions are poured into visible projects, the silent epidemic of depression, anxiety and suicide remains neglected. This neglect is not only unjust; it is economically reckless.

Less than one per cent of global charitable donations are directed towards mental health, even though the burden rivals – and often surpasses – that of heart disease, cancer, or diabetes. In Pakistan, where over 50 million people suffer from mental health conditions, this is not a marginal issue.

To read the whole article visit:

<https://www.dawn.com/news/1903912/another-layer-of-control>

"Rang e Yaran: Apna Camp Apni Story"

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It was inspiring to watch how every individual contributed in their own way.

Among the sessions, Expression of Thought, Storytelling, and Reflective Corner stood out as the most heart-touching parts of the camp. These moments allowed participants to express themselves freely through stories, poems, and personal reflections. I could see how deeply they connected with each other during these sessions and how the camp helped them discover new sides of themselves. In the reflection and feedback session, many participants shared how the camp helped them think differently and connect with their emotions. Listening to their thoughts made me realize how powerful such gatherings can be when they are built on understanding and purpose.

For me, Rang e Yaran was not just a camp; it was a journey of learning, connection, and growth. I felt proud to be part of a team that created such a meaningful space. It strengthened my belief in Yaran e Khair's vision of nurturing thoughtful and compassionate youth. The energy, creativity, and warmth I witnessed throughout the camp will always stay with me as a reminder of what we can achieve when we come together with sincerity and vision.

“Between the Breaths”

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I scream in silence, dry in tears,
I'm haunted by forgotten fears.
I call myself a loving soul,
But can't escape this broken role.

I'm sane enough to feel the sting,
Yet mad enough to break each wing.
I act with care, then fall apart—
Good deeds undone by aching heart.

But in this chaos, there's a spark,
A whisper glowing in the dark.
Maybe I'm lost, but not yet gone—
Still breathing, broken, still Shan.

“A call to action!”

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Would you rally your heart, your
resources, for free? For every life
shattered, every home torn apart,
The essence remains; it's a matter
of the heart. Let's set aside labels,
the politics, the blame Join hands
for the planet, ignite a new flame In
unity, we raise our voices in song,
For saving our future is where we
belong .

“Smiles that Teach”

Continued from page 2

Then it struck me: I could have fun
with them—so I did. My team and I
sang, danced, colored, and shared
moments that connected us more
deeply than any lesson plan could. I
remember Fira, a six-year-old girl
who became visually impaired
from a brain tumor. She loved to
dance, laughed whenever the
music sounded “silly,” and eagerly
practiced English with shining
enthusiasm. I came to teach, but
instead, the children taught me
that resilience is not taught—it is
lived. Their laughter carries
resilience, their smiles radiate it,
and their hearts keep it alive. By the
end, the questions of “Who are
you?” had turned into “When will
you come back again?”, and with a
smile, and teary eyes, I promised to
them “Soon”.



“DEMISE OF HOPES”

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was lying a handsome, tall man with
a brown beard that had turned red
from all the blood pouring down
from his skull. His hazel eyes were
shimmering like the stars as he
stared at the setting sun. The tough
ground beneath his weak body felt
like his mother's lap: warm and
gentle. He could sense his life
slipping away from his hand like the
sand slides from a grip, but there
was a peculiar calm on his face. He
could not even feel the pain
anymore because of all the desires
and dreams that were burning
inside his head. Every single face
was flashing like a movie clip before
his eyes. His hazel eyes holding
tears and a gentle smile adorning
his handsome face was a scene
worth a watch. He was struggling to
hold onto his life as his lungs were
gasping for air. The world, as we see
it, was fading before his eyes. All the
things he told his family he would do
on his return home in the last letters
he wrote a few weeks ago played
like a movie in his head. A single tear
slid down his left eye as his eyelids
shut down, leaving a forever calm
on his face. THE SACRIFICE Azan
was looking out the window of the
enormous vehicle, captivated by
the mesmerizing colors of the
setting sun. He had now entered a
small village. The valley was mostly
left abandoned owing to the
ongoing war, except for a few
families who would rather lose their
lives than leave their homes. And
why not? What are our lives but a
collection of glorious along with
unpleasant memories anchored to
the sights of our vivid backyards;
the smell of the rain-soaked sand;
the giggles of our parents, and the
hugs of our siblings?

Omit these memories, and we
are left with nothing but
boring tales of the every day
struggle to merely survive. The
vehicle had now left the
village, and the sights of
mostly abandoned homes and
mosques were replaced by
the endless plains that
seemed calm but were
holding hundreds of
landmines beneath the soil.
Azan had his sights locked on
the road. The excitement of
returning to his daughter was
rushing through his veins.
Suddenly, he got startled by
the screams of a goat piercing
through the silence that had
somehow lost its way from the
herd and was heading toward
the plains. Azan could see a
young girl wearing a red
dupatta running after the
goat, yelling at it to stop.
Azaan asked the driver to stop
the vehicle immediately. He
realized that the young girl
was rushing into the grounds
with sleeping bombs. Without
wasting any time, he exited
the vehicle and sprinted into
the field of landmines in an
attempt to save the little girl
who reminded Azan of
Pakeeza. Perhaps it was a
fatherly instinct, or maybe just
a human reaction to the
foreseeable calamity.
Whatever it was, it worked,
and the goat eventually
changed its course away from
the field. The little girl followed.
Once the girl was out of sight
and into the safe zone, Azan
could finally take a sigh of
relief as he stopped to catch
some breath. Little did he
know that his next step would
be his last.

